

FREE PATTERN

Free Crochet Newborn Baby Hat Pattern for Beginners

A small, soft beanie scaled down for a newborn head — a quick project for a gift or a hospital donation.

Updated 2026 • US terms • Fits 13–14in / 33–36cm head circumference



This hat is the smallest version of the same crown-shaping technique used across our [adult beanie](#) and [toddler beanie](#) patterns, stopped even earlier for a newborn-sized head. It's fast to finish and a popular project for hospital donation programs.

Baby safety note: use soft, machine-washable yarn with no small attachable parts such as buttons or bows, which can pose a choking hazard for infants. Many hospital donation programs specify these requirements directly. See the FAQ below for more detail.

MATERIALS

- 1 skein soft, machine-washable worsted-weight yarn (about 50–60 yards)
- 4.5mm (US size 7) crochet hook
- Stitch marker, to track the start of each round
- Scissors
- Yarn needle, for weaving in ends

ABBREVIATIONS (US TERMS)

ABBR.	MEANS
sc	Single crochet
st(s)	Stitch(es)
inc	2 sc in same stitch (increase)
rnd(s)	Round(s)

See our [abbreviations glossary](#) for the full list including UK terms.

 Soft pastel yarn skeins for a newborn hat

GAUGE

14 sc and 16 rows measures about 4in / 10cm square with a 4.5mm hook and worsted yarn. Fit depends more on gauge at this small size — check the flat crown circle against a newborn head circumference chart if an exact fit matters.

NOTES

- Written in US terms, worked in a continuous spiral — use a stitch marker to track round starts, same technique as our [adult beanie pattern](#).
- This is the smallest crown size on the site, stopping increases at round 5.
- Use soft, machine-washable yarn without buttons, bows, or other small attachments.

Pattern

ROUND 1

Make a magic ring, 6 sc into ring, place marker. (6 sts)

ROUND 2

Inc in every st around. (12 sts)

ROUND 3

[sc 1, inc] around. (18 sts)

ROUND 4

[sc 2, inc] around. (24 sts)

ROUND 5

[sc 3, inc] around. (30 sts)

ROUNDS 6–11

Sc in every st around, no increases. Work 6 rounds straight, or until the hat measures about 1in / 2.5cm less than the newborn's head circumference. (30 sts each round)

FINISHING

Slip stitch into the next stitch to close, fasten off leaving a 6in / 15cm tail.

Weave in ends with a yarn needle.

Frequently asked questions

What size head does this newborn hat fit?

This pattern is sized for an average newborn head circumference, roughly 13 to 14 inches. Premature or larger newborns will need a smaller or larger crown, adjusted by stopping the increase rounds one round earlier or later.

What yarn is safe for newborn hats donated to hospitals?

Many hospital donation programs require soft, machine-washable acrylic or cotton yarn without any small attachable parts like buttons or bows, since these can be a choking hazard for infants.

How long does a newborn hat take to crochet?

Given the small size, most beginners finish a newborn hat in about an hour, making it a quick, meaningful project for hospital donation programs or new parent gifts.

Written by Emily Hartwell

Emily has been crocheting for over a decade, ever since her grandmother taught her the basics one summer. She started CrochetGuides to write the clear, honest, beginner-friendly instructions she wishes she'd had when she was learning — the ones that actually work the first time.